

Grievance & Complaint Policy

This policy covers the formal process for raising, reviewing, and escalating workplace concerns, including complaints involving working conditions, management decisions, workplace practices, and employee treatment.

7.1 Informal Resolution. Employees are encouraged to discuss workplace concerns with their immediate manager when appropriate. Informal discussions should normally be attempted before submitting a formal grievance unless the concern involves the manager, requires confidentiality, or is otherwise unsuitable for informal resolution.

7.2 Formal Grievance. Employees may submit a formal grievance when a workplace concern cannot be resolved informally or when the employee believes formal review is necessary. Formal grievances should describe the concern, relevant events, dates, individuals involved, and any supporting information available to the employee.

7.3 Submission Deadline. A formal grievance should normally be submitted within 15 business days of the event or decision giving rise to the concern. Human Resources may accept a later submission when there is a reasonable explanation for the delay.

7.4 Initial Management Review. When a grievance concerns a manager's decision or workplace practice, the manager or designated reviewer should acknowledge receipt within 3 business days and determine whether additional information is required.

7.5 Human Resources Review. Employees may submit a grievance directly to Human Resources when the concern involves their immediate manager, when informal resolution is inappropriate, or when the employee believes the initial review did not adequately address the concern.

7.6 Supporting Information. Employees may provide relevant documents, messages, records, or other information supporting their grievance. Employees should distinguish between information they directly observed and information received from another person.

7.7 Investigation and Fact-Finding. Human Resources or another designated reviewer may interview the employee, managers, witnesses, or other relevant individuals when additional fact-finding is necessary. Employees participating in a review are expected to provide accurate information and cooperate with reasonable requests.

7.8 Initial Decision. Following review of a formal grievance, the designated reviewer will communicate the outcome to the employee. The outcome may include confirmation of an existing decision, modification of a workplace practice, additional review, or another appropriate corrective action.

7.9 Escalation. An employee who disagrees with the outcome of an initial grievance review may request escalation to the next designated review level. An escalation request should normally be submitted within 10 business days after the employee receives the initial decision.

7.10 Second-Level Review. A second-level review may be conducted by Human Resources, a department leader, or another designated reviewer who was not responsible for the original decision when reasonably practicable.

7.11 Final Internal Review. After completion of the second-level review, an employee may request a final internal review when the grievance involves a significant procedural concern or material information that was not considered previously. The request should normally be submitted within 5 business days of the second-level decision.

7.12 Confidentiality. Information relating to a grievance will be shared only with individuals who have a legitimate need to participate in reviewing or resolving the concern. Complete confidentiality cannot be guaranteed when information is necessary to conduct an appropriate review.

7.13 Protection Against Retaliation. Retaliation against an employee for submitting a grievance in good faith, participating in a grievance review, or providing relevant information is prohibited. Employees who believe they have experienced retaliation should report the concern through Human Resources or another designated reporting channel.

7.14 Anonymous Complaints. Anonymous complaints may be submitted through an available reporting channel. The organization may review an anonymous complaint when sufficient information is provided, although the ability to investigate or provide a response may be limited.

7.15 Records and Documentation. Records associated with formal grievances and their outcomes should be maintained by the designated department in accordance with applicable record-retention requirements. Employees should not alter or destroy relevant records after submitting a grievance.

7.16 Policy Compliance. Employees and managers involved in the grievance process are expected to follow the required procedures and cooperate with authorized reviews. Knowingly providing materially false information during a grievance review may result in disciplinary review.